PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Nissan Patrol Y62 / Armada

2010–present · Y62 · Z62 · Armada (2017–2024)

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Shift quality**
  CarSwitch says the RE7R01A seven-speed in early Y62s (2010–2014) has a reputation for valve-body problems, costing AED 5,000–12,000 to fix in the UAE. Test for harsh shifts, delayed engagement and shudder between second and third. One Australian owner reported his Y62 holding gears under hard acceleration while towing, even after a warranty transmission.

- [ ] **Signs of a hard desert life**
  CarSwitch's desert checklist: gouged skid plates and crossmembers, compacted sand in the frame rails and behind the inner guard liners, fine sand in the air filter, and ABS, stability or TPMS warnings on a cold start.

- [ ] **Patrol or Armada?**
  A US Armada has no rear locker, no disconnecting sway bars and no HBMC (AutoGuide). If you want a locker, you're shopping for a Patrol, and a Y62 Patrol isn't old enough to import into the US under the 25-year rule.

- [ ] **HBMC and lift kits**
  If the truck has HBMC, ask what's been done to it. One owner found HBMC front springs only come as complete shock-and-spring assemblies, and HBMC-specific kits such as Ontrack's are designed to fit without disturbing the system. Look for wet hydraulic lines and fittings at each corner and a truck that sits level.

- [ ] **Modifications and warranty**
  Cars.co.za advises avoiding heavily modified examples. One NissanPatrol.com.au member was told by his dealer that drivetrain problems wouldn't be covered after a lift.

- [ ] **Towing history**
  Owners report the rear of an HBMC truck sagging under heavy ball weights. Many towing rigs have airbag kits designed for HBMC. A transmission cooler or deep pan is a good sign on a truck that has towed.

- [ ] **Armada recalls**
  Check the VIN with NHTSA. The 2020–2021 Armada fuel-pump recall (21V373) replaces a pump whose impeller can swell and stall the engine. The 2026 campaign 26V455 corrects the axle-weight label on Armadas with 22-inch wheels.

- [ ] **Brakes and tyres**
  It's a heavy truck (a Warrior weighs 2,884 kg). Cars.co.za notes the weight wears brakes and tyres quickly, so check pad and rotor thickness and tyre wear before you price the truck.

YEARS TO KNOW

2010–2012	BEWARE	Early trucks: CarSwitch flags transmission valve-body issues and early fit-and-finish problems

2015–2017	SWEET SPOT	CarSwitch's value sweet spot for used Y62s: it says most early-production mechanical kinks had been sorted by then
2019	SWEET SPOT	Second Patrol facelift with a new front end and Nissan Intelligent Mobility driver aids. CarSwitch and Westside Auto rate these 2020-on facelift Patrols as the most desirable used Y62s

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Rear-view camera image can be turned off**
  2018–2019 Armada · NHTSA 19V-654
- ☐ **Fuel pump impeller can swell and bind**
  2020–2021 Armada (V8) · NHTSA 21V-373
- ☐ **Incorrect axle weight rating on certification label**
  2020–2026 Armada with 22-in wheels · NHTSA 26V-455

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Armada vs Patrol**
  A US Armada has no locking differentials, no disconnecting sway bars and no HBMC (AutoGuide).
- ☐ **HBMC or not**
  HBMC trucks have hydraulic lines running to each damper. The Desert Edition used regular suspension (Wikipedia), and so did every Armada.
- ☐ **Series and parts**
  Parts change by series. Patrolapart lists different thermostats for Series 1–2 and Series 3-on trucks (from February 2016) and two different timing chains for some 2016–2017 Series 3 trucks. Give your parts supplier the VIN.
- ☐ **Warrior**
  Premcar's 2023 Warrior has 323 mm of ground clearance, 295/70R18 Yokohama all-terrains, a 2.5 mm steel front bash plate and a 3,620 kg GVM (4X4 Australia).
- ☐ **Nismo**
  The Gulf-market Nismo has a 319 kW (428 hp) V8, Bilstein dampers and 22-inch forged wheels (Wikipedia).

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/nissan-patrol/y62/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks